

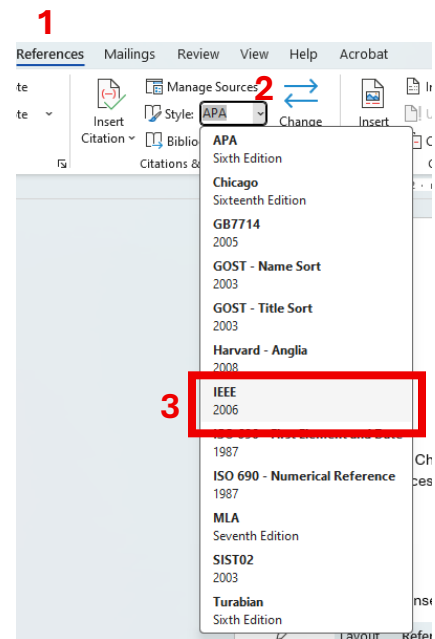
How to insert citations and generate a list of references

Please read Chapter 9 of the textbook to get an understanding of the requirements for citations and references and to learn the terminology used below.

Word

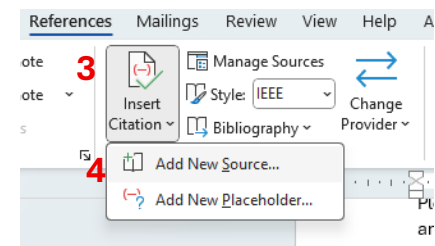
In Word, use the IEEE citation method, which is the most common in our field. It's a numerical system like you might have seen on Wikipedia. Using the numbers, in square brackets, is discreet and doesn't interrupt the flow of the reading.

1. Activate the References Ribbon
2. Click on the dropdown menu for citation styles
3. Select the IEEE citation style.



To insert a citation for a new source

1. Place your cursor where you want to insert the citation
2. Activate the References Ribbon (if it isn't already)
3. Click on Insert Citation
4. Click on "Add New Source"



5. Select the source type.
6. Select “Show All Bibliography Fields.”
7. Fill in those fields – all the ones you can.

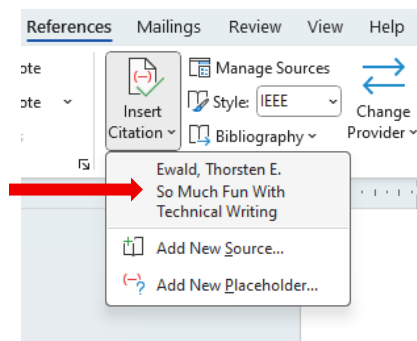
Note: a prompt at the bottom of the fields will show you how to fill in the fields properly, for instance whether to use an author’s full first name or just an initial or whether to spell out the month or represent it numerically.

Note: fill in either the publication date (preferable, if you can find it) or the date accessed, not both.

8. Click “OK”

At this point, the citation (source number in square brackets) will appear where your cursor is and the source will be stored for future uses and to generate a List of References (see below).

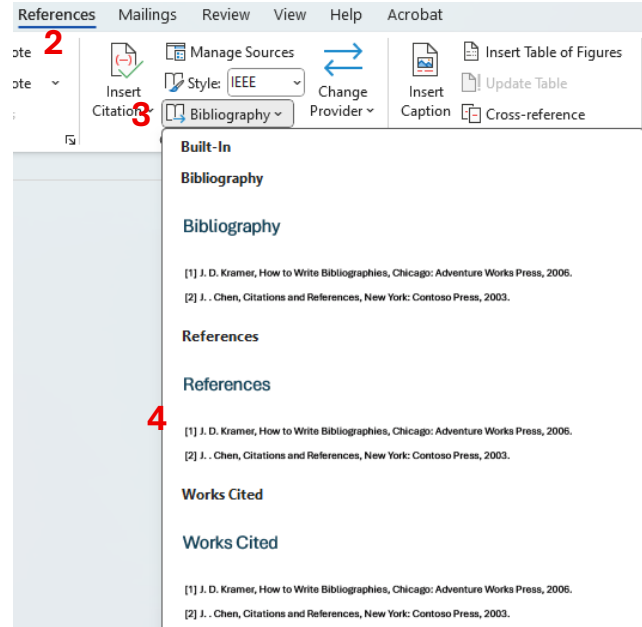
All sources that you’ve created will be listed in the Insert Citation dropdown menu. Simply click on it to insert the citation.



To create a list of references

1. Place your cursor where you want the list of references to start.
2. Activate the References Ribbon, if it isn't already
3. Select "Bibliography"
4. Select "References"

The only difference in our case will be the heading that Word inserts: References.
Results shown below.



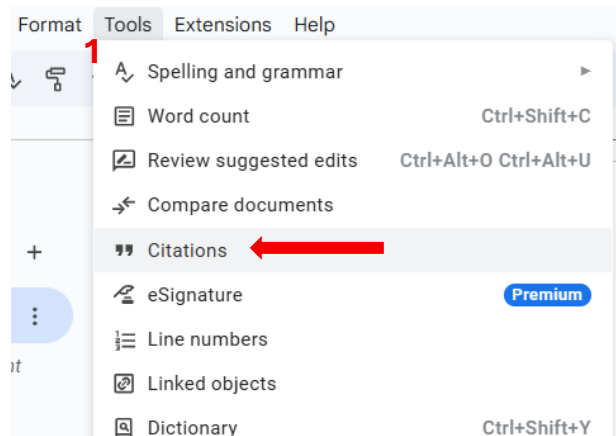
References

- [1] T. E. Ewald, "So Much Fun With Technical Writing," [Online]. Available: www.techwritingisecstasy.ca/so_much_fun. [Accessed 18 October 2025].

Googledocs

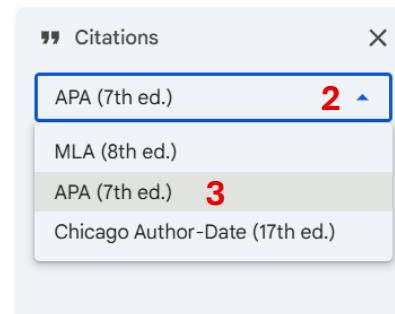
Googledocs does not support the IEEE citation method, so we'll use the APA method.

1. Click on Tools > Citations



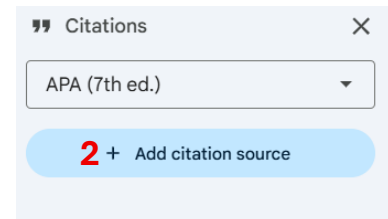
This will activate the citation docker in the right margin of the page.

2. Click on the citation method dropdown menu on the docker
3. Select APA (7th ed)



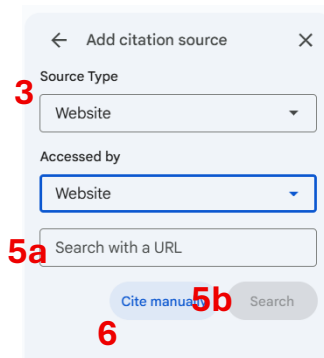
To insert a new citation

1. Place your cursor where you want the citation to appear in the text
2. Click "Add citation source" in the citation docker.



This will open the citation selection docker page

3. Select the Source Type
4. Select Accessed By (kind of obvious in most cases, but it changes how the citations are filled out)
5. If you found your source online (highly likely),
 - a. Paste the source URL into the "Search with a URL" field.
 - b. Click "Search"



Googledocs will fill in the information fields for the citation automatically, mostly and most of the time.

6. If your source does not have a URL or google cannot find the source based on the URL, click on “Cite Manually”

This will open the citation field dialogue box.

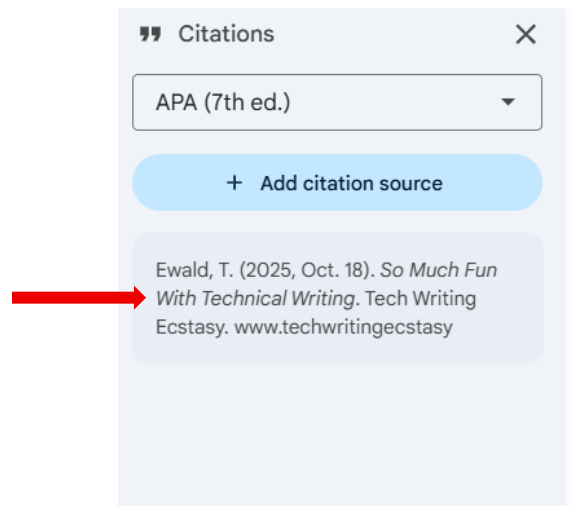
7. Fill in the fields as much as you can.

Note: fill in either the publication date (preferable, if you can find it) or the date accessed, not both.

8. Click “Add citation source

At this point, the citation will appear where your cursor is, and the source will be stored for future citation insertions and to generate the list of references (see below).

To insert a citation for a source you’ve already created, simply select it from the citation docker (see below).

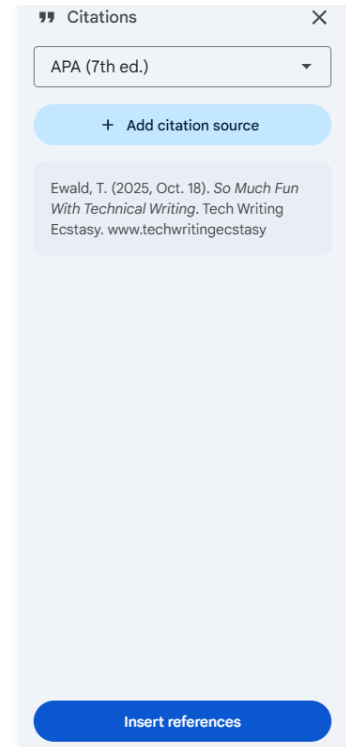


The screenshot shows an 'Add website' dialog box. It has a back arrow and a close 'X' button at the top. The 'Accessed by' dropdown is set to 'Website'. There is a checkbox for 'Corporation/organization' which is unchecked, and a blue link for '+ Contributor'. The 'Title*' field contains 'So Much Fun With Technical Writing'. The 'Website title*' field contains 'Tech Writing Ecstasy'. The 'URL*' field contains 'www.techwritingecstasy'. The 'Published day*' field contains '18'. The 'Published month*' field contains 'Oct.'. The 'Published year*' field contains '2025'. At the bottom is a blue button with a red number 8 and the text 'Add citation source'.

To create a list of references,

1. Place your cursor where you want the list of references to appear.
2. Activate the citation docker
3. Click “Insert references”

At this point, googledocs will generate the list of references (see below).



References

Ewald, T. (2025, Oct. 18). *So Much Fun With Technical Writing*. Tech Writing Ecstasy.
www.techwritingecstasy